NO. 16 · ABOUT 200-150 BC

The Oldest Copy of the Book of Enoch



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The Bible quotes a book that isn't in your Bible. Here is its oldest copy.

> And Enoch also, the seventh from Adam, prophesied of these, saying, Behold, the Lord cometh with ten thousands of his saints, To execute judgment upon all, and to convince all that are ungodly among them of all their ungodly deeds which they have ungodly committed, and of all their hard speeches which ungodly sinners have spoken against him.
>
> JUDE 1:14–15 · KJV

FOUND
1952, in Cave 4 at Qumran, one of eleven Aramaic copies of Enoch found there

SEE IT TODAY
The Dead Sea Scrolls collection of the Israel Antiquities Authority, Jerusalem

What it is

Brown fragments of leather in Aramaic, from the book now called 1 Enoch. It tells of Enoch, who 'walked with God' (Genesis 5:24), and of the Watchers who came down before the Flood.

What it shows

Jude, in the New Testament, quotes Enoch almost word for word: 'Behold, the Lord cometh with ten thousands of his saints.' The Qumran copies show the book was being read in the land well before Jude wrote.

What scholars still ask

Its dates come from the handwriting. The Ethiopian Orthodox Church counts 1 Enoch as scripture; most churches do not. Early Christians read it; Augustine set it aside. It was never 'banned'; it was simply left out of most Bibles.

TALK ABOUT IT

Jude quoted a book that isn't in most Bibles. What do you make of that?

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